



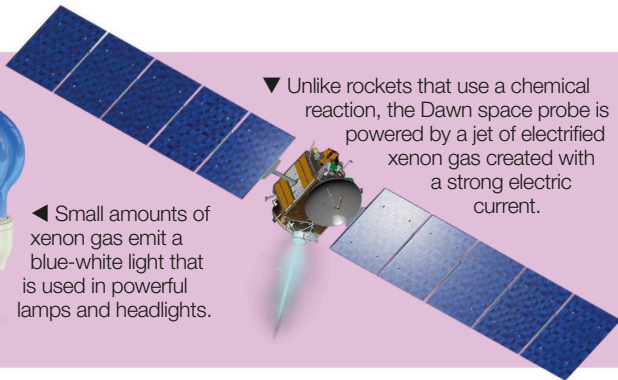
FOCUS ON... XENON

Xenon has several specialist uses – as an anaesthetic, in bright light bulbs, and even as spacecraft fuel.



◀ Small amounts of xenon gas emit a blue-white light that is used in powerful lamps and headlights.

▼ Unlike rockets that use a chemical reaction, the Dawn space probe is powered by a jet of electrified xenon gas created with a strong electric current.



Krypton

36
Kr

This element's name comes from the Greek word "kryptos", which means the "hidden one". Krypton is naturally present in the air, but it is 20 times less abundant than neon. It is primarily used in lasers and in flash bulbs for high-speed photography.

ATOMIC MASS 83.798

STATE Gas

DISCOVERY 1898 (Sir William Ramsay and Morris Travers)

This light is given out by krypton gas when it is electrified.

Pure krypton in a glass sphere



Xenon

54
Xe



Pure xenon in a glass sphere

A balloon filled with xenon does not float, but drops straight to the ground. This is because this gas is five times heavier than air. Xenon is mixed with air in the atmosphere, but out of every 10 million atoms in the air, only one is xenon.

ATOMIC MASS 131.293

STATE Gas

DISCOVERY 1898 (Sir William Ramsay and Morris Travers)